

9. STRUGGLE FOR AN EDUCATION

EXERCISE 1- POST READING**Q.1: Why was the boy inspired to go to Hampton?**

Answer: In the story Booker T. Washington presents an account of a significant event of his life. He used to work in a coal mine where he happened to know about a very good school in Virginia. This school was far better than the one in his town. The name of this school was the Hampton Normal and Agricultural Institute in Virginia. The story also brings into limelight the struggle and hardships the Blacks and the people of the coloured race had to face to be identified and make their presence felt in a society predominated by racism.

The boy (the writer) was inspired to go to Hampton because of its reputation being more pretentious than the school of his town. The school provided opportunities for poor but worthy students who could work out all or a part of the cost of board. At the same time, they could also be taught some trade or industry.

Q.2: After working in the coal mine where did the boy work next and what did he learn?

Answer: In the story Booker T. Washington presents an account of a significant event of his life. The story depicts a saga of struggle and determination of the author on the road to attain good and quality education.

After working at the coal mine, the boy found employment at the household of General Lewis Ruffner, the owner of the salt-furnace and coal-mine. He was hired at a salary of \$5 per month. There, he learned values of honesty and frankness, to do things promptly, systematically and to keep the house clean and well maintained.

Q.3: What happened to the money he had earned at Mrs. Ruffner's house?

Answer: The small amount of money that he had earned at Mrs. Ruffner's house. had been consumed by his stepfather and the remaining family members, with the exception of a very few dollars. So he had very little money with which he could buy clothes and pay his traveling expenses.

Q.4: What did he do in Richmond in order to reach to Hampton city?

Answer: He saw a cargo ship unloading pig-iron. The kind-hearted captain of the ship gave him work and he finally earned his breakfast for the day. Due to his good work the captain asked him to continue work. He still slept under the sidewalk and finally managed to save money to reach Hampton.

Q.5: Why did the writer thank the captain?

Answer: In the story Booker T. Washington presents an account of a significant event of his life. The kind-hearted captain of the ship gave him work and he finally earned his breakfast for the day. Due to his good work the captain asked him to continue work. He still slept under the sidewalk and finally managed to save money to reach Hampton. So, before leaving, the writer thanked the captain of the ship for allowing him to unload the ship. He had earned enough money to reach Hampton.

Q.6: Why could the writer not make a favorable impression upon the head teacher?

Answer: The writer could not make a good impression upon the head teacher because He was hungry and dirty. He was also without bathe and changing of cloth.

Q.7: What did he have to go through in order to get admission in the Hampton Institute?

Answer: The teacher did not refuse admittance neither did she decide in favour. She kept giving admission to other students which troubled him all the more. He desperately wanted a chance to prove his worth. He had to display his skills, determination and sincerity towards his aim to achieve quality education. He swept and dusted the room several times as he knew that his future depended upon it. The teacher came and inspected the room minutely and could not find a bit of dirt. She finally admitted him to the school.